



Symphony of the Seas — 7-Night Western Caribbean

Round-trip from PortMiami · Royal Caribbean

Ship: Symphony of the Seas · **Sailing from:** PortMiami · **Cabin:** _____

A condensed Voyage Pack from [In the Wake](#) — the essentials in three pages. The full pack covers cabins, packing, budget, ship orientation, ports in depth, Royal's quirks, and the cruise rhythm.

Day by day

#	Day	Port	Hours ashore	Tender	The one thing
1	Sat	PortMiami — embarkation	board 11:00 AM – 3:30 PM; depart 4:00 PM	—	All-aboard 3 PM. Sailaway past Star Island and Government Cut.
2	Sun	Cruising at sea	—	—	Settling-in day. Book Royal Caribbean shows in the app.
3	Mon	Roatán, Honduras	~8:00 AM – 5:00 PM	dock at Coxen Hole (Port of Roatán)	West Bay Beach (~\$6–10 r/t taxi) or snorkel the Mesoamerican Reef.
4	Tue	Costa Maya, Mexico	~9:00 AM – 6:00 PM	dock	Easiest port — pool complex inside the gate, or Chacchoben ruins (\$50).
5	Wed	Cozumel, Mexico	~9:00 AM – 7:00 PM	dock	Palancar Reef snorkel (\$50 indep / \$95 ship). The trip that converts non-snorkelers.
6	Thu	Cruising at sea	—	—	Recovery day. Specialty walk-up at 4 PM.
7	Fri	Perfect Day at CocoCay	~7:30 AM – 4:00 PM	dock	Coco Beach Club (\$110), Thrill Waterpark (\$60), or the free Chill Island and South Beach.
8	Sat	PortMiami — debarkation	off by 10:00 AM	—	Uber to MIA \$30–45.

Three group specialty dinners typically fit Royal's rhythm: Chops Grille (steakhouse), Jamie's Italian, and either Wonderland (tasting menu, splurge) or Izumi (sushi/hibachi).

CocoCay closes occasionally for weather — Caribbean tropical, brief 30-min squalls. Reef-safe sunscreen earlier than you think.

Currency aboard: USD. **Auto-gratuity:** ~\$18.50/day per person.

Decide before you board. Run the [drink-calculator](#) on your real drinking pattern, the [budget-calculator](#) for the total-fare picture, and the [tipping-calculator](#) for auto-grats + cash tips — mid-sail upgrades cost more per day and give you fewer days of usage.

Getting to the ship — and getting home

Arrival: Friday recommended, Saturday required

Friday — fly in. Same-day Saturday flights to a 3:30 PM all-aboard are risky. Pre-cruise hotel in Brickell, Downtown Miami, or Miami Beach gives margin and lets you use Friday afternoon for Wynwood, South Beach, or Little Havana.

Saturday — embarkation.

- **Terminal: Royal Caribbean Terminal A** at PortMiami (verify your assignment).
- **MIA → PortMiami:** Uber/Lyft \$30–45, 20–30 min. Taxi flat-rate \$32.
- **FLL → PortMiami:** Uber/Lyft \$60–90, 45–60 min.
- **If driving:** Terminal AA garage **\$35/day** (~\$245/week, firsthand May 2026 — verify); offsite Miami long-term lots \$7–14/day with shuttle.
- **Embark window:** 11:00 AM – 3:30 PM. **All-aboard 3:00 PM.** Ship departs 4:00 PM.
- **Royal app online check-in** — complete before arrival.

Day 8 debark and the trip home

- **The night before:** bags in the hall by ~11 PM with color-coded tag.
- **6:00 – 8:00 AM:** Breakfast at the Windjammer or a sit-down room.
- **7:00 AM:** Customs clearance complete. Self-disembarkation begins.
- **7:30 – 10:00 AM:** Walk-off in waves. All passengers off by 10:00 AM.

Carry-on with you: change of clothes, all medications, passport, phone charger, valuables.

Getting from PortMiami to MIA. Uber/Lyft on Saturday afternoon, **\$30–45, 25–30 min.** Don’t overthink it.

Killing 4–6 hours before an evening flight:

- **Bayfront Park / Bayside Marketplace** — 10-min walk.
- **Pérez Art Museum Miami (PAMM)** — 15-min walk. \$20 entry. Air-conditioned.
- **Brickell** — short Uber. Cuban coffee, lunch, Uber to MIA when ready.

Airport-arrival timing.

Flight	Leave PortMiami by
Domestic, after 4 PM	1:30 PM
International, after 6 PM	2:30 PM

MIA TSA lines run 30–60 min during Saturday-afternoon cruise rush.

Areas of interest during the cruise

On the ship — Symphony spots worth knowing

- **The Boardwalk** — Coney Island-style outdoor neighborhood with the AquaTheater at the back, hand-carved carousel, and Johnny Rockets.
- **Central Park** — open-air park neighborhood with 12,000+ live plants, walking paths, restaurants, classical music in the evenings.
- **Royal Promenade** — the indoor “main street” running the ship’s length; parades, shops, pubs.
- **Ultimate Abyss** — 10-deck slide from Deck 16 down to the Boardwalk. The most signature Oasis-class feature.
- **Solarium** — adults-only glass-domed pool deck. Quiet pool day in the Caribbean.
- **Vitality Spa thermal-suite day pass** — sea-day intro rates.
- **AquaTheater** — open-air water-and-acrobatics show; book in the Royal app.
- **Two70°** — wraparound aft glass lounge; morphing video walls; evening shows.

Sea-day priorities (Day 2 + Day 6)

1. **Sunrise coffee on the Boardwalk or Central Park** — neighborhoods empty in the first hour.
2. **Book the AquaTheater show** in the Royal app before they fill.
3. **Ultimate Abyss** first hour after opening — no line.
4. **Vitality Spa thermal suite** — sea-day morning intro rate.
5. **Specialty dining reservation** for Day 6 evening — Chops, Jamie’s, Wonderland fill.

Specialty dining picks

- **Chops Grille** — Royal’s steakhouse standard.
- **Jamie’s Italian** — Jamie Oliver pasta and pizza; family-friendly.
- **Wonderland** — Royal’s “imaginative cuisine” tasting menu; the splurge experience.
- **Izumi** — Japanese; sushi + hibachi rooms.
- **Hooked Seafood** — New England-style seafood.

Port-day picks (one each)

- **Roatán** — West Bay Beach via taxi (~\$6–8/person each way) with offshore reef snorkeling. The day most cruisers come for. Snorkel tour to the Mesoamerican Reef (\$35–55 indep) is the upgrade.
- **Costa Maya** — pool complex inside the gated port is free with your cruise card (easiest day). Chacchoben Mayan ruins (~\$50 indep / ~\$80 ship) is the cultural choice.
- **Cozumel** — Palancar Reef snorkel tour (~\$50 indep / ~\$95 ship). Two hours, calm water, the conversion experience. Or Mercado Municipal in San Miguel for real Mexican shopping (skip the pier tourist shops).
- **CocoCay** — Free Chill Island and South Beach are the included choice. Coco Beach Club (\$110) is the adults-quiet upgrade. Thrill Waterpark (\$60) is for adventure-seekers.

Photo spots worth knowing

- **Sailaway from Central Park or the Boardwalk** — Star Island superyachts, Miami skyline at golden hour.
- **Ultimate Abyss top platform** — 10-deck drop perspective.
- **AquaTheater show** — high-dive acrobatics + projection.
- **Roatán West Bay Beach** — turquoise water + reef visible offshore.
- **CocoCay overlook** from the Solarium deck — turquoise lagoon below.

Need an at-home emergency handoff card? Separate one-page doc available from [In the Wake](#). The full Voyage Pack is the unabridged companion document. Soli Deo Gloria.